

Plutarch/Government

U.S.





About the Course

Students study a life by Plutarch for two terms and then spend the rest of the year exploring topics of government through historical documents and decisions from this rotation.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 9 (U.S.)



Placement & Combining Tips

Plutarch lessons are shared with Grades 6-8, and the final term of government lessons is shared with Grades 10-11, and are also suitable for inquisitive 8th graders.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9	Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) 1 time/week 30 min	The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised) Reading PDF

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 9 (U.S.)				
Ethics: Part 3 Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12				Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) Current Events: Grades 9-12



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.)



The Plutarch Project Volume Three (Revised)



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.)

∞ [Video: How to Teach Plutarch \(see Citizenship: Section 7\)](#)

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Community Read Alouds](#)

∞ [Setting Up a Citizenship Notebook](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.)

How To Approach



Prepare

Teachers may find it helpful to pre-read all or part of the selection from Plutarch studied and choose which news sites to offer students.

If you, the student, are learning at home, work to schedule a time with your teacher when you can complete the lessons from *Ourselves and Plutarch* together, as these lessons are much richer when shared and discussed.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources: Scan the headlines first to get an overview, and then choose a story to read.

For Citizenship books (optional): Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to get yourselves interested in the lesson. If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding. It is not necessary to cover all unfamiliar words.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves and Plutarch*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Have students keep an eye out for things to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, and/or Commonplace book.



Narrate

Narrate orally or in writing.



Discuss

Share your thoughts on the story and any connections made. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions together to discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Record important ideas in your Citizenship Notebooks. Make a calendar of current events.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 1

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: We highly recommend reading a retelling so you can be familiar with the story. This is for your understanding and should not be read to the students.

∞ Link: Retelling of Caesar (from Our Young Folks' Plutarch)

- Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ INTRO

Have you ever heard of Julius Caesar? If so, what do you know about him?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Julius Caesar Image

∞ Video Link: Julius Caesar Video

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Take 1-2 minutes to look over the map of the Roman Republic and the surrounding "world" in Caesar's time.
2. Find Rome in Italy.
3. Find the Aegean Sea between the province of Asia and Achaia. This is the coastline where the pirates operated.
4. Find Bithynia on the southern shore of the Black Sea, where Caesar went after his release.
5. These are the places where a teenager on the wrong side of Roman politics spent his first years away from home.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson One: Parts One - Three p.9-12

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" + "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

In the introduction of Lesson One, we learn that "young Julius Caesar was on the wrong side. Most people in that position would have stayed hidden or at least tried to live quietly" (p.7). In a situation where staying silent means comfort and safety, what factors or beliefs might make a person decide that standing up is worth the risk?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

If you found yourself on the "wrong side" of a big decision at school or with your friends, and staying quiet was the only way to stay safe and comfortable, how would you decide which ideas are worth being "exiled" for and which ones are just you being stubborn?

★ TEACHER TIP

∞ Link: Character Cards

To keep track of all of the characters in the story, it may be helpful for your student to keep a list or chart of some kind in their citizenship notebook. They could also sketch the characters and include facts about them. Or, you could use the linked character cards.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Watch this overview video to help with the Character Simulator

∞ Video Link: Character Simulator

• CHARACTERS

-**Julius Caesar (JOOL-yus, SEE-zar):** Roman statesmen and general, held many high civic, military, and religious positions, and was a noted orator and writer.

-**Sulla (SUH-luh):** was made the Perpetual Dictator, but resigned after one year and was elected as a consul instead.

-**Cinna (SIN-uh):** There are several Cinnas in the story. This Cinna, Lucius Cornelius Cinna the Elder, is Caesar's first father-in-law and ally of Marius, Caesar's uncle.

-**Marius (MARR-ee-us):** involved in a Civil War against Sulla and was an ally of Cinna, the father-in-law of Caesar

-**King Nicomedes (nih-kuh-MEE-deez):** King of Bithynia 94-74 BC

-**Marcus Juncus (MAHR-kuss, JUNG-kuss):** governor of Asia in 75 BC

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Term 1

WEEK 2 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 2

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What did we learn so far about Caesar from the first reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Hither Spain and Farther Spain on the western edge of the map. Both are already "Roman Pink."

2. Find the Alps. This is the route Caesar traveled when he passed through a tiny village and said, "For my part, I had rather be the chiefest man here, than the second person in Rome" (p.15, The Plutarch Project).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful to write definitions into the text, so you do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Two: Parts One - Three p.14-17

• Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a young officer who rode with Caesar when he passed through a tiny village in the Alps and said he would rather be the first man there than the second in Rome. What do you think about that comment?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Explain how you might distinguish between a person who wants to do great things and a person who simply wants to be the greatest.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The map shows the world in 31 BC, shortly after Caesar's time. You will notice Italy is shaded pink; while it was the Roman Homeland and not a province, it is colored here to show it was under central Roman control.

While all of Gaul is pink on this map, remember that when Caesar began his command, only the southern tip belonged to Rome. His campaigns are what eventually brought the rest of that territory into the Empire.

• DEFINITIONS

Pontifex Maximus: There were numerous levels and types of priesthood in Rome and throughout the rest of Italy, and these positions carried political as well as spiritual authority.

• CHARACTERS

-Catulus (kuh-TUL-uhs): an avowed enemy to the Marian (Marius's) party

-Isauricus (eye-SAW-rih-kus): a consul and general who fought against the Cilician pirates

-Crassus (KRAS-us): Roman senator and a conspirator against Caesar

-Cato (KAY-toe): statesmen that had many conflicts of opinion against Caesar

-Alexander (al-ig-ZAN-der): Alexander the Great

-Calpurnius Bibulus (kal-PUR-nee-us, BIB-yoo-lus): consul alongside Caesar

WEEK 3 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 3

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

★ TEACHER NOTE

Germania was entirely outside Roman control.

- The Rhine was the line Caesar pushed against, even crossing it twice (in 55 BC and 53 BC) to build famous bridges and conduct show of force expeditions.

- Despite these incursions, Rome never successfully turned the main body of Germania into a permanent province, even in the

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Term 1

1. Find Transalpine Gaul and the Rhine River marking the boundary between Gaul and Germania.
2. Notice that Germania is entirely outside the Roman pink. This is the boundary Caesar was about to push.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Three: Parts One - Three p.19-23

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Caesar's soldiers who has watched him for days while he was ill and exhausted. Tonight he is sick again. What do you think about his choices while chronically ill (p.22)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Describe the different ways Caesar and his companions responded to the dish served by their host in Milan (p.23).

centuries following Caesar.

• CULTURAL CONNECTION

Sweet Ointment: also translated "oil of perfume" or "myrrh." It appears that Valerius Leo hadn't just pulled out the wrong bottle of salad dressing, but rather that he was trying to show off his wealth. The reference to the host's want of breeding seems to confirm that.

• CHARACTERS

-**Servilius Caepio (ser-VIL-ee-us, SEE-pee-oh):** engaged to Caesar's daughter, Julia

-**Piso (PEE-so):** consul in 58 BC

-**Clodius (KLOH-dee-us):** interrupted a women's religious ritual and was the cause of Caesar's divorce from Pompeia

WEEK 4 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 4

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find the Rhine separating Gaul from Germania.
2. Find Cisalpine Gaul south of the Alps.
3. Trace north from Cisalpine Gaul all the way to the Rhine. This is the distance those men were willing to march.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Four: Parts One - Four p.26-30

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Caesar "never failed to dismiss all with present pledges of his kindness in hand, and further hopes for the future" (p.29). As one of his soldiers, you've just watched him march over a bridge of fallen soldiers. Now, he stands before you, gives you gold, and speaks of the future with hope. How do you make sense of the leader you saw at the river and the generous, hopeful man standing in front of you now?

• CHARACTERS

-**Labienus (lay-bee-EE-nuhs):** tribune, one of Caesar's lieutenants, but a supporter of Pompey

-**Ariovistus (ar-ee-oh-VIS-təs):** leader of the Suebi people, one of a group of Germanic tribes

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Term 1

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar "commanded them that were afraid, that they should depart home, and not put themselves in danger against their wills" (p.27-28). How would you respond if you were one of the "young gentlemen of noble houses of Rome, who thought to have gone to the wars with him as only for their pleasure and gain" and Caesar was sending you home (p.27)?

WEEK 5 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 5

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Arverni, where Vercingetorix and the Arverni lived.
2. Find Alesia. Notice the rivers and terrain, and consider why Caesar chose to build where he did.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Five: Parts One - Two p.32-36

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Vercingetorix, riding out of the gates of Alesia in full armor to give yourself up. What do you think about the choice you are making?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Look closely at the rivers surrounding Alesia. How might these help a general trying to keep an army from escaping?

• CHARACTERS

-**Ambiorix** (am-bee-OR-iks): leader of the Eburones from Gaul

-**Quintus Tullius Cicero** (KWIN-tuss, TUL-lee-uss, SIS-er-oh): military leader during Caesar's Gallic Wars

-**Vercingetorix** (VUR-sin-JET-uh-riks): king of the captured Arverni tribe

WEEK 6 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 6

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find the Rubicon.
2. Locate Brundisium on the Adriatic coast.
3. Find Dyrrhachium across the Ionian Sea and notice the distance Caesar was asking his army to cross.
4. Consider the risk of moving a massive force across that stretch of the Ionian Sea while being hunted by an enemy fleet.

• CHARACTERS

-**Antony** (AN-tuh-nee): Mark Antony

-**Scipio** (SIH-pih-oh): senator, consul, and military commander

-**Lentulus** (LEN-tyoo-lus): consul

-**Asinius Pollio** (uh-SIN-ee-us, POL-ee-oh): Roman orator and historian

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Term 1

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Six: Parts One - Two p.38-42

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Asinius Pollio, standing beside Caesar at the Rubicon while he talks through what crossing will mean. What do you think as you listen to him (p.41-42)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

On the banks of the Rubicon, Caesar's abstract plan shifts to the reality of the action. Describe what he sees and feels in that moment of doubt as he considers the "desperateness of his attempt" (p.41).

WEEK 7 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 7 *Julius Caesar p.42-50*

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Trace the route Caesar used to move through Italy in sixty days without a major battle.
2. Find Corfinium, where Domitius surrendered.
3. Locate Brundisium, where Pompey escaped by sea.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Seven: Parts One - Four p.45-49

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Labienus, Caesar's most trusted general for ten years, the night you walked out of his camp for the last time. What do you think about the man you are leaving (p.46)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar said, "Time of war and law are two things" (p.47). What does he mean?

• CHARACTERS

-Domitius (duh-MISH-ee-uhs): enemy of Caesar and Cato's brother-in-law

-Publius Servilius Isauricus (PUB-lee-uhs, ser-VIL-ee-uhs, eye-SAWR-ih-kuhs): co-consul and friend of Caesar

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WEEK 8 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 8

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find the city of Rome in Italy and cross the Adriatic Sea to the province of Macedonia, the rugged region where the Battle of Pharsalus was fought.
2. Find Pharsalus.
3. Trace the coastline south to Alexandria and the Kingdom of the Ptolemies, where the defeated Pompey eventually fled for refuge.
4. These are the locations where the future of the Roman world was decided as Caesar pursued his rival across the Mediterranean.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eight, Parts One - Three p.51-56

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Caesar's soldiers who ran to meet him when he returned to shore, and you are angry. Your general just risked his life sneaking across a war zone in a twelve-oar boat dressed as a slave, without telling anyone. What specifically bothers you about what he did, and what does your reaction say about what you believe a leader owes the people who follow him?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar's plan to aim at the faces of the young cavalymen worked because he thought carefully about who they actually were, not just what they were doing on the battlefield. Describe a conflict or disagreement you have had where understanding the other person's specific fears or weaknesses would have changed how you approached the situation.

★ TEACHER NOTE

The writing prompt is slightly uncomfortable by design, because understanding someone's fears in order to respond more effectively sits right on the edge between wisdom and manipulation.

• CHARACTERS

-**Spinther (SPIN-ther)**: nickname for Publius Cornelius Lentulus

-**Gnaeus Domitius Calvinus (NEE-us, doh-MISH-ee-us, cal-VYE-nus)**: general and consul and loyal to Caesar

-**Quintus Cornificus (KWIN-tus, cor-NIF-ih-kus)**: quaestor for Illyricum

-**Calenus (kuh-LEE-nuhs)**: Roman general and consul

WEEK 9 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 9

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Alexandria on its Mediterranean coast. This is where Caesar spent

• CHARACTERS

-**Cleopatra (KLEE-oh-PA-truh)**: co-ruler of Egypt with her brother, Ptolemy XIV

-**Pothinus the Eunuch (PAH-thin-uhs)**: high-ranking servant of King Ptolemy XIII and regent of Ptolemy XIV

-**Achillas (uh-KILL-uhss)**: guardian of King Ptolemy and one of the murderers of Pompey

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Term 1

months managing a dangerous court, a burning library, a treacherous eunuch, and a queen smuggled in through a castle gate in a bundle. He nearly drowned here.

2. Move northeast into Syria, which Caesar passed through on his way to deal with the next problem before the Egyptian one was fully settled.

3. Find Pontus on the southern shore of the Black Sea. This is where Pharnaces had overrun Roman territory while Caesar was occupied in Alexandria. Caesar arrived, fought, and sent a three-word letter back to Rome. The whole thing was over before the letter arrived.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Nine: Parts One - Three p.58-61

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Pompey's soldiers who has just been taken prisoner and is now being folded into Caesar's legions. Yesterday, you were fighting against this man. Today, he is your general. What do you do with that, and what would you need to see from him before you trusted him (p.58-59)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1

Caesar "daily saved the lives of some of his countrymen that bore arms against him" and considered this the greatest pleasure of his victory. Think of a conflict, whether between people, groups, or ideas, where the most meaningful thing a winner could do afterward was show restraint or generosity. What makes that kind of choice hard, and what makes it worth it (p.59)?

"Veni, Vidi, Vici" worked because it was short, precise, and matched the reality of what had actually happened. Think of a time when you had to report something, explain yourself, or sum up a complicated situation for someone else. What is lost when we say too much, and what is lost when we say too little (p.61)?

-Caesarion (see-ZAR-ee-on):

Caesar's son and last pharaoh of Egypt

-Pharnaces (FAR-nuh-seez): his father conquered many territories, including Bithynia and Cappadocia

WEEK 10 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 10

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Sicily, where Caesar camped on the seashore in winter to cut off any thought of delay.
2. Then trace his crossing south to the African coast and the battle at Thapsus, where three camps fell in a single day.
3. Follow him back to Rome for the triumphs and the honors, then west to Spain and the battle at Munda, where Pompey's sons nearly killed him, and back to Rome again. He covered all of this inside two years.

• CHARACTERS

-Scipio (SIH-pih-oh): senator, consul, and military commander

-King Juba I (JOO-buh): King of Numidia

-Gaius Asinius Pollio (GAY-us, uh-SIN-ee-us, PAHL-ee-oh): soldier, politician, historian, and writer

-Afranius (uh-FRAY-nee-us): former consul and Pompey's lieutenant in Spain

-Juba II (JOO-buh): King of Numidia and Mauretania, scholar and author, raised in Rome by Caesar and his nephew

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→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Ten: Parts One - Three p.64-68

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of Caesar's friends who has just urged him to accept a personal bodyguard, and he has refused, saying it is "better to die once than always to be afraid of death." You believe there are real plots against him. How would you respond to his answer (p.68)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Caesar put a man of the right family name at the head of his troops specifically to counter an oracle his enemies believed in. He may have been mocking it, or he may have been sincere; Plutarch says it is hard to tell. Think about a time when you did something that could have been interpreted two very different ways depending on who was watching. Do your intentions fully determine the meaning of an action, or does it matter how others read it (p.65)?

WEEK 11 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 11

Julius Caesar

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome. Now stay there, because that is where the entire lesson takes place. After a life of crossing seas and marching through impassable terrain, the whole lesson fits inside a single city.
2. Find Philippi in Macedonia, where Brutus and Cassius died by their own hands.
3. Trace the distance between those two points.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eleven: Parts One - Three p.70-74 and Lesson Twelve: Parts One - Epilogue p.77-82

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR: PICK 1

You are a senator who walked out when Caesar refused to stand up to greet you. You said nothing. You just left. What were you communicating, and do you think he understood it?

• CHARACTERS

-**Brutus (BROO-tuss)**: wanted to preserve the Roman Republic and allied with a group of senators to murder Caesar

-**Tillius Cimber (TIL-ee-us, SIM-ber)**: called Metellus Cimber in Shakespeare's play

-**Casca (KAS-kuh)**: struck the first blow in the murder of Caesar

-**Octavius Caesar (ok-TAY-vee-us, SEE-zer)**: later known as Caesar Augustus

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Term 1

You are Caesar in the moment before you cover your face and give up. You have fought off the others. You are still standing. And then you see Brutus. Something finally stops all the fight in you. You have outrun everything your whole life. What is it that you are finally deciding to stop outrunning (p.78)?

→ **WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1**
You have served Caesar since his early campaigns. You have watched him win in Gaul, survive civil war, defeat Pompey, and return to Rome in triumph. He is now planning new campaigns as if none of it had happened. What does it feel like to follow a man who cannot stop? What do you think he is still looking for?

The crowd killed Cinna the poet because he had the same name as Cinna the conspirator. He tried to tell them who he was, and it made no difference. Think about a situation where a person was judged entirely by something they had no control over. What does that kind of mistake reveal about what happens to people's judgment when they are driven by grief or rage (p.80)?

WEEK 12 30m **Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 12**
Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**
Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Plutarch Project Volume 3

Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.)

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Term 2

WEEK 1 📅 **30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 13** **Week 1 / A Young Nation: American Government from 1800 to 1900**

→ INTRO

Welcome back to American Government! Last year you learned about the formation of the American Government and the reasoning behind why the Constitution and Bill of Rights were drafted and negotiated as they were. This year, we move forward to the period from 1800 to 1900 and study the way in which the new government began to take action and shape the first hundred years of our country's history.

Note: One week is built in at the end of this term for “catch up” reading, in case you miss a week or a reading takes you longer than your allotted time to complete. Please do not skip ahead if you have not completed the lesson from the week before – work through the weeks chronologically and use the catch up week (Week 11) as necessary.

→ READING

- Read Week 1 of your Reading PDF.
- With any time that you have remaining, read your summary statements and skim any written narrations from the last two years of American Government. Your summary statements should cover the time periods from Rotation 1 (800 CE - 1650 CE) and Rotation 2 (1650 CE - 1800 CE).

→ REFLECT

- Talk about the summary statements you have reviewed with your teacher or classmates. What did you remember? What had you forgotten? Did anything come to mind as you were reviewing that you had not thought about before?
- *Teacher Note: Optional Activity: Guide students in creating a bulleted list of key words that they noticed while reading their summary statements or during their discussion. Key words can be words that were repeated frequently, or that stood out to the student for any particular reason (there is no “right” set of key words). This activity is optional because it requires students to exercise a higher level analysis and might not be a useful reflective tool for all students.*

WEEK 2 📅 **30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 14** **Week 2 / Western Expansion and the Missouri Compromise (1820)**

→ INTRO

- The United States nearly doubled in size following the purchase of the Louisiana Territory from France. As new states began to petition Congress for entry to the country, the issue of slavery began to divide the nation. In 1820, Congress passed the Missouri Compromise, defining geographical boundaries that would determine whether slavery would be legal in new states. The Compromise would be followed by a series of legislative acts that together attempted to bind the new country together in the face of rapid land expansion and deep divides over slavery.

→ READING

- Read Week 2 in your Reading PDF.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

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Term 2

WEEK 3 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 15

Week 3 / Western Expansion and the Compromise of 1850

→ INTRO

- Although the Missouri Compromise remained in effect, the acquisition of the western territory from Texas to modern-day California following the Mexican-American War reignited the question of whether new states formed from this territory would be admitted as slave states or free states. In order to maintain a tentative balance of slave to free states across the nation, Congress passed the Compromise of 1850 after efforts to ban slavery entirely from the new territory failed.

→ READING

- Read Week 3 in your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 4 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 16

Week 4 / Western Expansion and the Kansas-Nebraska Act

→ INTRO

- The Kansas-Nebraska Act of 1854 repealed the Missouri Compromise in its entirety and allowed the new territories of Kansas and Nebraska to decide the question of whether slavery would be allowed in the territories to be decided by popular sovereignty – by a vote of the people of the territories. Violence stemming from pro-slavery and abolitionists clashes in Kansas and in Washington, D.C. earned the nickname “Bleeding Kansas” and foreshadowed the start of the Civil War.

→ READING

- Read Week 4 of your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Consider the three major pieces of Congressional legislation that you have studied over the last three weeks: the Missouri Compromise, the Compromise of 1850, and the Kansas-Nebraska Act. Why do you think that Representatives and Senators in Congress increasingly decided to turn the slavery question over to popular vote? What benefits are there to a popular vote? What drawbacks or dangers might there be to a popular vote?

- Write a summary statement or short narration explaining your thoughts in response to these questions.

WEEK 5 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 17

Week 5 / Treaties and the Removal of Tribal Nations (Part I)

→ INTRO

- Treaties are a tool that the Constitution allows the President to use in order to make formal agreements between the United States and another nation. Over the first four decades of the 19th century, the United States began to engage in treaty-making with American Indian Tribes, located in what are now the southern states of Tennessee, Alabama, Georgia, Florida, and Mississippi, with the goal of removing these Tribes from the south and relocating them west of the Mississippi River.

→ READING

- Read Week 5 in your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

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WEEK 6 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 18 *Week 6 / Treaties and the Removal of Tribal Nations (Part II)*

→ INTRO

- With the Indian Removal Act of 1830, Congress indicated their support for the removal of tribes, specifically authorizing then President Andrew Jackson to use treaties to effect land exchanges, trading land west of the Mississippi to tribes in exchange for tribal land in the south. But was the Indian Removal Act constitutional, and were the treaties themselves enforceable? We will explore the Act and its impact further in this week's reading.

→ READING

- Read Week 6 your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 7 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 19 *Week 7 / Tribal Nations before the Supreme Court*

→ INTRO

- While President Jackson and Congress worked to remove Tribes from the south by means of treaties and federal legislation, the Cherokee Nation sought to enforce their treaty rights before the Supreme Court. Over the course of two decisions within the span of the same number of years, the Supreme Court set precedent that would define the rights and status of Tribes into the modern day, and by extension, undermined the integrity of the federal government's treaty-making with these Tribes. The Indian Appropriations Act, passed in 1871 by Congress, would end treaty-making with Tribes altogether.

→ READING

- Read Week 7 in your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 8 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 20 *Week 8 / Congress & Southern Secession*

→ INTRO

- On December 20, 1860, South Carolina seceded from the United States. Over the next seven months, ten more states would follow suit. Four of these states drafted formal Declarations of Causes that set forth their justifications for secession. This week we will explore these Declarations in more detail and consider the impact that southern secession had on the federal Congress the states left behind.

→ READING

- Read Week 8 in your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Consider how the various southern secession documents compare or contrast from the Declaration of Independence. What strikes you as similar or different? Among other things, you want to think about the organization or length of the documents, the reasons given for separation, and historical events ongoing at the time that each document was signed. *Teacher note: If you have a group of students, pose this question for group discussion as an alternative to traditional narration. If you are the only student in your class, jot down some of the similarities or differences that you think of.*

- Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

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WEEK 9 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 21

Week 9 | Congress & the Reconstruction Acts

→ INTRO

- Following the end of the Civil War and preliminary reconstruction efforts by President Johnson, Congress exerted control over the Reconstruction project by passing a series of acts now known as the Reconstruction Acts. These Acts, passed over a presidential veto by Johnson, established military control in southern states that had seceded and established strict standards for readmission to the Union.

→ READING

- Read Week 9 in your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 10 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 22

Week 10 | "Defective from the Start": The Constitution, Slavery, & the Civil War Amendments

→ INTRO

- In addition to taking control of Reconstruction following the close of the Civil War, Congress also proposed three amendments to the Constitution. These amendments, now known as the Civil War Amendments, banned slavery and established a series of protections and rights that are now foundational to how we think about citizenship in the United States. It would be five years before these amendments were fully ratified by the states, and it would be nearly a hundred more years until the Civil Rights Movement would take up the vision for justice and equality that these amendments had begun to advance.

→ READING

- Read Week 10 in your **Reading PDF**.

→ REFLECT

- Narrate. Write a summary statement or short narration describing the main ideas from this week's reading.

WEEK 11 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 23

Week 11 | Reading Day

→ ASSIGNMENT

- Catch up on reading you have not completed for this term.

- Review your summary statements in chronological order so that you have a complete picture of how our readings relate to each other.

WEEK 12 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 24

ASSESSMENT

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 25

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP:

• We highly recommend reading a retelling so you can be familiar with the story. This is for your understanding and should not be read to the students.

∞ Link: Our Young Folks' Plutarch - Tiberius Gracchus

∞ Link: Our Young Folks' Plutarch - Caius Gracchus

• Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Tiberius and Caius Gracchus

∞ Video Link: Tiberius Video

∞ Video Link: Gaius Video

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome in the center of Italy.

2. Locate Carthage in North Africa.

3. Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus were the grandsons of Scipio Africanus, the Roman commander who defeated Hannibal at the Battle of Zama in 202 BC.

4. Notice the distance between Rome and Africa; this family's influence spanned the Mediterranean world before the boys were even born.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson One: Prologue - Part Two p.160-163

• Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a Roman citizen watching the two brothers walk through the Forum. Read the descriptions of the brothers on pages 161 and 162. Which brother would you trust more to lead a revolution, and why?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch notes that Cornelia's education of her sons "prevailed more than nature" (p.161). Do you think a person's upbringing can entirely change their natural temperament?

• CHARACTERS

-**Scipio #1 (SKIP-ee-oh):** Roman general and grandfather of Tiberius and Gaius

-Scipio #2 (SKIP-ee-oh):

adopted grandson of Scipio #1, destroyer of the city of Carthage

-King Ptolemy VIII (TAH-luh-mee):

king of Egypt

-**Appius Claudius (AP-ee-uhs, CLAW-dee-uhs):** consul

WEEK 2 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 26

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

• CHARACTERS

-**Fannius (FAN-ee-us):** an orator and historian

-**Gaius Mancinus (GUY-us man-SEE-nus):** consul, captured by Numantines, returned to Rome, but stripped of his seat in the Senate

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Term 3

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Carthage, where Tiberius "was first to mount the walls" (p.165).
2. Find Numantia in the northern part of Hither Spain. This is rugged, difficult territory.
3. Trace the long route from Rome, across the sea, and into the Spanish mountains. This is where Tiberius saved 20,000 Roman lives.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Two: Parts One - Two p.165-167

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a Roman soldier trapped in the mountains of Numantia. Your Consul has failed, and you are surrounded. The enemies refuse to speak to anyone but Tiberius Gracchus. How does it feel to have your life depend on the reputation of one young officer (p.165)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

You are a Numantine governor. You have just captured the Roman army's entire payroll and the young officer's records. Your people hate Rome. Why do you treat this specific young man like a guest of honor instead of a prisoner of war (p.166)?

WEEK 3

📍 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 27

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

📍 Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

📍 Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome.
2. Now, trace a line with your finger northward along the western coast toward the Alps. This region (modern-day Tuscany) is where Tiberius looked out at the vast estates.
3. Imagine the "Roman Pink" on your map isn't a country owned by its people, but a giant puzzle where only a few wealthy men own all the pieces.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Three: Parts One - Three p.169-172

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

• CHARACTERS

-Gaius Laelius (GUY-us, LAY-lee-us): Roman general and friend of Scipio #1

-Mucius Scaevola (MEW-shus, SEV-uh-luh): lawyer, consul, and high priest

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→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are a wealthy Senator. You bought land legally (or so you claim) years ago. Now, a young Tribune tells you that you must give it back to the poor. Tiberius says the soldiers "have nothing but air and light" (p.171). How would you respond?

→ WRITE (Optional Citizenship Notebook Exercise)

If you were a soldier who just returned from the wars in Spain, how would you respond to Tiberius's speech (p.171-172)?

WEEK 4 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 28

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

Find Rome. Tiberius "sealed up" the gates of the Temple of Saturn in the city of Rome to stop the economy until his law was passed (p.175, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Four: Parts One - Two p.174-177

• Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Marcus Octavius, Tiberius's friend and fellow Tribune. You believe the land law is dangerous for Rome's stability. Your best friend is now asking the people to fire you from your job. How would you respond?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Tiberius and Octavius were "vehement" against each other, but used no "foul words" (p.174). Why do you think Plutarch chose to tell us that?

• CHARACTERS

-Marcus Octavius (MAHR-kuhs, ok-TAY-vee-uhs): orator and elected tribune

-Fulvius #1 (FOOL-vee-us): consul

WEEK 5 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 29

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find the Kingdom of Pergamum (in modern-day Turkey/Asia Minor).
2. King Attalus died and left his entire kingdom to Rome. Tiberius wanted to take that royal wealth and give it directly to the poor to buy tools for their new farms. "That made him again more hated of the Senate than

• CHARACTERS

-Publius Nasica (POOB-lee-uhs, nuh-SY-kuh): cousin of the Gracchi, also a Pontifex Maximus (chief priest) and consul

-King Attalus of Pergamon (AT-uh-lus, PUR-guh-mon): left his kingdom to the Romans to avoid bloodshed, very scholarly

-Titus Annius (TY-tus, AN-ee-us): consul

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before" (p.180, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ **VIEW & PRACTICE**

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ **READ & NARRATE**

Lesson Five: Parts One - Three p.179-182

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ **DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR**

You are a member of the Senate. Tiberius has just proposed that the inheritance of King Attalus should be "distributed among the poor citizens" to furnish them for their new farms (p.179). How would you respond?

→ **WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)**

Tiberius said, "But when he goeth about to take away the authority and power of the people, then he is no more a tribune" (p.181). Do you agree with that definition of leadership?

WEEK 6 30m **Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 30**

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ **RECAP**

What happened in the last reading?

→ **LOCATE**

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

Find Rome. Here, "were slain above three hundred men," including Tiberius (p.187, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ **VIEW & PRACTICE**

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ **READ & NARRATE**

Lesson Six: Parts One - Two p.183-187

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ **DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR**

You are a supporter of Tiberius. You see him touch his head to signal he is in danger, but "his enemies, seeing the sign he gave, ran presently to the Senate, and declared that Tiberius desired the people to bestow a crown upon him, as if this were the meaning of his touching his head" (p.186). Suddenly, a mob of Senators comes charging out of the meeting, armed with broken chair legs. Do you stay to fight, or do you flee?

→ **WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)**

• **CHARACTERS**

-**Blossius (BLOSS-ee-us):** philosopher of Cumae

-**Flavius Flaccus (FLAY-vee-us, FLAK-us):** supporter of the Gracchi

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Tiberius was killed by a fellow Tribune with the "foot of a chair" (p.186). Plutarch notes that not one man was killed with an "iron weapon" (p.187). Why do you think Plutarch pointed this out?

WEEK 7 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 31

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas p.14-15

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome in Italy. The Tiber River flows through it, though it is not labeled on this map. This is where the victors threw Tiberius's body, denying him a burial.
2. Now find Sardinia, the island to the southwest. This is where Gaius was sent as Quaestor to keep him away from the political fires in Rome.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Seven: Parts One - Two p.189-191

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Gaius Gracchus. Your brother is dead, his friends were executed, and you have just had a dream where Tiberius tells you, "Brother, why dost thou prolong time...we were both predestined to one manner of life and death" (p.191). How do you feel about the dream?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch says of Gaius that "some were of opinion that he was more popular, and desirous of the common people's good will and favour, than his brother had been before him" (p.191). Do you think it was a compliment?

• CHARACTERS

-**Aristonicus** (uh-riss-tuh-NEE-kus): original name of Eumenes III of Pergamon

-**Publius Crassus** (POOB-lee-us, KRASS-us): a high priest and consul, father-in-law of Gaius Gracchus

-**Orestes** (oh-REST-eez): consul and then proconsul in Sardinia

WEEK 8 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 32

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Find Rome in Italy. The Field of Mars lies just outside its walls, though it is not labeled on this map. Plutarch says so many people came to vote for Gaius that "the Field of Mars not being large enough to hold such a multitude of people, there were that gave their voices upon the top of houses" (p.194, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).
2. Now find Sardinia to the southwest. This is where Gaius "not only

• CHARACTERS

-**King Micipsa** (my-KIP-suh): king of Numidia

-**Popilius** (puh-PIL-ee-uhs): consul

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excelled all the young men of his age in his actions against his enemies" but also "in temperance, frugality, and industry, he surpassed those who were much older than himself" (p.193).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Eight: Parts One - Three p.193-197

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are one of the censors hearing Gaius defend himself. He tells you he "alone of all men else that had been in the wars, had carried his purse full, and brought it home empty: where others having drunk the wine which they carried thither in vessels, had afterwards brought them home full of gold and silver" (p.194). What do you think about his defense?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch says that where all other orators turned toward the Senate, Gaius, "in contrary manner when he made his oration, turned him outwards towards the other side of the marketplace" (p.196-197). Plutarch calls it "a little turning." What do you think it meant?

WEEK 9 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 33

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

Find Capua. This was one of the major cities where Gaius wanted to send poor citizens to live.

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Nine: Parts One - Two p.199-202

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

Plutarch writes, "He won the good will of the common people, being more popular and familiar in his conversation and deeds than he was otherwise in his orations" (p.200). Consider the *Lives* we have studied this year. What role does a person's personality play in their success?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

The Senate has hired a rival, Livius Drusus, to "play the demagogue" and

• CHARACTERS

-**Fabius (FAY-bee-uhs):** vice praetor, governor of Spain, and consul

-**Gaius Fannius (GUY-us, FAN-ee-us):** consul

-**Livius Drusus (LIV-ee-uhs, DROO-suhs):** appointed tribune for the sole purpose of counter-offering anything that Gaius Gracchus proposed

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outbid you. While you offer two colonies for the "honestest citizens," he offers twelve colonies for the "poorest," letting them have the land "scot free" (p.201). As Gaius, how do you defend your laws in this situation?

WEEK 10 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 34

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

Look at the sea south of Capua. Gaius sailed across this water to Carthage to build a city named "Junonia." While there, a storm blew away his sacrifices, and wolves stole his boundary marks (p.204-205, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ VIEW & PRACTICE

Review the vocabulary section before each lesson to familiarize yourself with unfamiliar terms. It may be helpful for students to write definitions into the text, so they do not have to review terms mid-lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Lesson Ten: Parts One - Two p.203-205

Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR

You are Gaius, back in Rome. You see one of your "familiar friends" being dragged to prison by the Consul's officers. You have promised to protect your allies, but you "pass by without assisting him," claiming you don't want to pick a quarrel. What are you thinking (p.205)?

→ WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE)

Plutarch wrote, Gaius "came now to take a house near the marketplace, to show himself nearby the lowlier and more popular" (p.205). Why do you think he moved?

• CHARACTERS

-Fulvius (FUL-vee-us): aka Flavius Flaccus, supporter of the Gracchi

-Lucius Opimius (LOO-shus, oh-PIM-ee-us): consul

-Gaius Fannius (GUY-us, FAN-ee-us): consul

WEEK 11 30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 35

Tiberius and Gaius Gracchus

Materials: The Plutarch Project Volume 3, Historical Atlas

PREP: Read the introduction, review vocabulary, and preread the lesson.

→ RECAP

What happened in the last reading?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas p.14-15

1. Look at the city of Rome. The conflict has now moved from laws and speeches to the streets themselves.

2. Visualize the Capitol, where both parties met "by break of day." The peace is broken when an attendant named Antyllus is slain with "great bodkins to write with" rather than swords (p.209, The Plutarch Project Volume 3).

→ READ & NARRATE

Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.)

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

Lesson Eleven: Parts One - Two p.208-211 and Lesson Twelve: Parts One - Epilogue p.212-215

- Once finished, ask, "What do you remember?" and "What else?" Keep narration to 2-3 minutes.

→ **DISCUSS: CHARACTER SIMULATOR - PICK 1**

Plutarch wrote, "Gaius would not arm himself, but went out of his house in a long gown, as if he would have gone simply into the marketplace" (p.210). What do you think about his choices?

You are a guest at Cornelia's home in Misenum. She tells the story of her sons' deaths "without shedding a tear," as if she were telling a history of someone else. Some guests think she has lost her "reason and sense" from grief. Do you agree (p.215)?

→ **WRITE (OPTIONAL CITIZENSHIP NOTEBOOK EXERCISE): PICK 1**

Gaius' wife says, "Alas, what hope or trust is left us now, in laws or gods, since they have slain Tiberius" (p.211)? What kind of loss do you think she is describing?

The people eventually built statues of the Gracchi and "consecrated the places where they had been slain." Looking back at their lives, did the Gracchi brothers "win" or "lose" their battle for the Roman people (p.215)? Why?

WEEK 12 **30m Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.) - Lesson 36**
Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
The Plutarch Project Volume 3

Plutarch/Government: Grade 9 (U.S.)

Examination

Term 1

- Tell me everything you remember about the life of Julius Caesar.
- You are a Roman citizen who lived through all of it. Caesar was on the wrong side as a young man, nearly drowned escaping, nearly starved at Pharsalus, made himself dictator for life, died in the Senate chamber, and was declared a god three days later. The city burned. The men who killed him were hunted to their deaths. Now it is quiet. Was Rome better or worse for having had him? Why?
- You are someone who admired Caesar deeply and also someone who could see clearly what he was becoming. Those two things were both true at the same time for most of the people closest to him. Think about a person in your own life, a figure in history, or a character from a story, in whom you can see greatness and destructive behavior running alongside each other. What do you do with admiration that you cannot separate from concern?
- You have followed Caesar from his early campaigns through every battle, every crisis, every triumph, and into Rome at the end. You have watched him grab sailors, swim through fire, feed horses seaweed, pardon enemies, refuse bodyguards, and finally cover his face and stop when he saw Brutus. Looking at the whole of what you witnessed: what did this man actually want, and did he ever get it?

Term 3

- Tell me everything you remember about the lives of the Gracchi.
- The brothers were nothing alike, and everything alike. Tiberius was gentle and restrained. Gaius was feisty. Think of a time when you had to choose between patience and urgency, when both paths seemed right, but for different reasons. Which did you choose? What happened? Which brother do you think you are more like, and which one do you think you should try to be?
- You have followed the Gracchi from Cornelia's house through every assembly, every law, every riot, and into the silence after. You watched Tiberius weep before his father's statue on the last morning of his life, and keep walking. You watched Gaius pull his hand quietly from his wife's grip at the door and not look back. You watched Cornelia lose both sons and go on hosting dinner parties for learned men without shedding a tear. What do you think about their behavior? Is there a right way to face grief, loss, and fear?